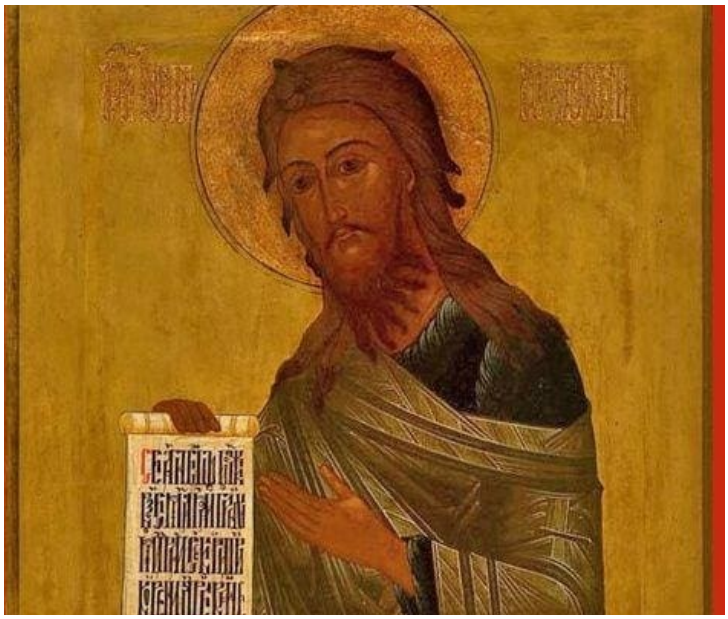
Our Lady of the Valley

8 MARCH, AD 2026

33 Adams Street, Easthampton, MA 01027 (413) 527-9778



St. John the Forerunner

Sunday Mass Schedule

Saturday Vigil 4:00pm

Sunday 8:00am| 10am | 11:30am (TLM)

(Mass in Polish last Sunday of the month at 8:00am)

Daily Mass Schedule

Monday | Tuesday | Thursday| Friday: 8am

Wednesday 6pm

Saturday 9am

Eucharist Adoration after the Friday 8am Mass

Live Stream on YouTube:

Daily Mass, Saturday 4pm, Sunday 8:30am

OLV Masses are televised on Channel 191

Thursday & Friday at 3pm

Saturday & Sunday at 2pm

Ministry to the Sick & Shut-ins

Please contact the rectory if you become unable to attend Mass & wish to receive Holy Communion.

Office Hours

Monday - Thursday 8am - 3pm

Parish Staff

Rev'd Ryan Sliwa - Pastor
fr.sliwa.olv@gmail.com ext. 160
Rev'd Mr. Lawrence Channel—Deacon
deacon.channel.olv@gmail.com
Henry Dabek - Business Manager
dabek.olv@gmail.com ext. 100
Dan Rattelle - Parish Clerk
rattelle.olv@gmail.com ext. 110
Katie Sadakierski - Director of Religious Ed.
sadakierski.olv@gmail.com

In Residence

Rev'd Barrent Pease
Rev'd Philippe Roux

Facilities: Joey Mongeau
Dave Paquette

Confession

Saturday 3:00 -3:45pm
Before each daily 8am Mass
After the 6pm Mass on Wednesdays

Baptism

2nd Saturday|1pm| See Webpage

Holy Matrimony

Contact the rectory at least one year in advance.

Please consult the Pastor prior to setting the date.

Prayer Line

Please call the rectory at 527-9778. Prayer Intentions are prayed for 2 months. Reinstate if necessary.

LITURGICAL ROLES

Weekend of

Mar. 8	**Lector**	**EMHC**
4:00pm	P. Wallace	M. Bouthilette
8:00am	T. Brown	
10:00am	A. Bialek	

Mar. 15	**Lector**	**EMHC**
4:00pm	T. Kowalski	
8:00am	M. Lecko	B. Campbell
10:00am	D. Zuchowski	E. Zuchowski

HYMNS FOR WORSHIP

Jesus, the Very Thought of Thee, #591

Lord Jesus, As We Turn from Sin, #613

Praise to the Holiest in the Height, #717

Mass Parts: Missa Simplex #133

250,000 HAIL MARYS

All in our parish family are invited to participate in our 250,000 "Hail Mary" prayers challenge as we offer two of our daily "Hail Mary" prayers for our Confirmation candidates, and our third "Hail Mary" prayer each day for the repose of the soul of Mary Largent Byrne, the mother of our diocesan bishop. Please collect a new prayer card and calendar of daily intentions to track your prayers offered for our special petitions from the organizer by the prayer card collection box in the church vestibule (entryway), by the statue of Mother Mary (near one of the flights of stairs leading up to the choir loft). At the end of each month, please submit your prayer cards by placing them in the box. Thank you so much!

NO SERMON THIS MONDAY

Father will be out of the parish on Monday March 9th. Lenten sermons will resume the following Monday, March 16th at 5:30pm.

FRUITS OF THE MASS

Saturday, March 7

9:00am †Leon Lecko — Family

4:00pm †Bill Whichelow — Lorraine & Tom Morse

Sunday, March 8

8:00am †Janet, †Stanley, & †Paul Growhoski — Carol & Chuck Growhoski

10:00am †John Potorak — Family

11:30am *Missa Pro Populo*

Monday, March 9

8:00am †Etta Deacon — Friend

Tuesday, March 10

8:00am †Leonard Milczarek (6th *Anniv.*) — Loving Sister & Brother-in-Law Eleanor & Albert Korsak

Wednesday, March 11

6:00pm †Wiktoria Urban — Children

Thursday, March 12

8:00am †Stanley Banas — Loving Family

Friday, March 13

8:00am †Judith Caputo (1st *Anniv.*) — Loving Niece Eleanor Korsak

Saturday, March 14

9:00am †Joseph & †Kathleen Brosseau — Elaine LaChapelle

4:00pm †Helen Kowalski (10th *Anniv.*) — Loving Family

Sunday, March 15

8:00am †John Knight — Family

10:00am †Raymond E. Duda — Loving Wife & Children

11:30am *Missa Pro Populo*

CANDLE INTENTIONS

MARCH 9 – 15

Sanctuary Lamp

Veronica Bozek—Madelyn Bozek Baladi

Black Madonna

Leon Lecko — Family
In Thanksgiving

Statue of Our Lady

Raymond E. Duda — Loving Wife & Children
Helen Dowdy — Rita

Tabernacle

Joan Sieracki—Grandchildren
Joseph Sieracki, Sr. — Grandchildren

DIVINE MERCY PRAYER GROUP

OUR DIVINE MERCY Prayer Group will meet at 6:30pm on Wednesday, **March 11th.** The service includes recitation of the Chaplet of Divine Mercy, Rosary, Confession, & Exposition & Benediction of the Blessed Sacrament.

GILDA BURNETT SCHOLARSHIP

The OLV Women's Club is offering a $500 scholarship for a high school senior who will be attending college in the fall and a $300 scholarship for a student who will be entering a Catholic High school for the first time next year. Applications are currently available and can be accessed on the OLV website or by contacting:

Anita Ulshoeffer at 413-527-5354 or aulshoeffer5354@charter.net

Completed applications and all supporting documentation **must** be received by April 30, 2026 – attn: Women's Club Gilda Burnett Scholarship Committee. This opportunity is available to all eligible young members of the OLV Parish. So parents, grandparents and friends are asked to encourage qualifying students to apply.

IRISH NIGHT

The Knights of Columbus are hosting an Irish Night on March 21st. There will be a traditional corned beef dinner and desserts starting at 5PM. Fr. Sliwa will give a spiritual talk around 5:45PM, and then entertainment will be provided by the Claddagh School of Irish Dance around 6PM. The cost is $20 per ticket, $10 for 12 years old and under. Tickets will be available from the Knights of Columbus after each weekend Mass. Please text or call Mike McManus at 413-535-6246 with any questions.

Angel's Attic Hours:
Thursdays 4pm - 7pm
Saturdays 9am - 1pm
email: **angelsattic01027@gmail.com**

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GORZKIE ZALE

Polish Bitter Lamentations | Wednesdays in Lent 5:30pm

5TH SUNDAY ROSARY

Join the Knights of Columbus in the recitation of the Holy Rosary just after the 8am Mass on Sunday, March 29th.

THIS WEEKEND!

Today, the Knights of Columbus will be hosting the Thomas Gallivan Memorial Scholarship fundraising breakfast on Sunday, March 8th from 8-11:45am in the Church Hall. Help us raise money for the two $1,000 scholarships awarded to our graduating seniors of Our Lady of the Valley Parish. Cost $10 for adults, $6 for children up to 10 years old, children under 5 are free. The menus includes scrambled eggs, pancakes, sausage, juice, and coffee.

COFFEE SHOP

After the 8am Mass. All items still just $1. Hosted by:

March 8 No Coffee Shop, Scholarship Breakfast
March 15 Mission Committee
March 22 Knights of Columbus

FROM RELIGIOUS EDUCATION

Adult Education

- A liturgical rosary prayer group session will be held in the parish library on Monday, March 9, 2026, at 3:30 p.m. in honor of our priests. We will offer the Joyful Mysteries of the Holy Rosary for the priests in our diocese, praying for them by name, bead by bead, to rejoice in the gift of each of their ministries. Praying for the intercession of St. Frances of Rome, St. Aloysius Gonzaga, and St. Dominic Savio, we will petition Jesus, the Eternal High Priest, for every blessing on our priests, in thanksgiving for all that they do to bless souls. Prayer texts will be provided as we offer special meditations befitting the occasion.
- On Tuesday, March 10, 2026, at 6:00 p.m. in the parish library, join us in our preparations to celebrate the spiritual beauty of St. Patrick's Day by praying the Chaplet of St. Patrick, making St. Brigid crosses from rushes, and making spiritual bouquet cards honoring the Irish saints to extend their Irish blessings to others. We will facilitate a visio divina prayer session, reflecting on the masterpiece that is the Book of Kells, and will pray to open our hearts to being illuminated by the love of the Holy Spirit.
- Our concluding Seven Sisters Apostolate book club session culminating our conversations on *The Life of Mary as Seen by the Mystics* will take place on Friday, March 13, 2026, at 3:30 p.m. in the parish library. We will wrap up our discussion with reflection questions on chapters 29-37, but will ultimately ponder in our hearts how we can keep our heart-to-Heart conversations with Our Lady going, so that we can keep growing in friendship with our Blessed Mother, after having learned more about her life, and the special role that she plays in our lives. All women of the parish interested in learning more about Our Lady, and how we can imitate her in our ministry of prayer for priests, are welcome to join our Seven Sisters Apostolate members for this special book club presentation and discussion, which does not require prior reading for participation.

PK-12 Religious Education

- A meeting for religious education program catechists/volunteers will be facilitated on Thursday, March 12, 2026, at 5:00 p.m. in the parish library. Please join us in planning to make our program all the more special.
- Our spring Confirmation retreat will be offered for Confirmation candidates and sponsors on Saturday, March 14, 2026, between 8:00 a.m. and 12:00 p.m. We will meet in the parish hall, and entrust our day to the Immaculate Heart of Mary as we strive to grow closer to God, preparing our hearts to receive the Holy Spirit more fully in the sacrament of Confirmation.
- Our next religious education program class for PK-12 program families will be held on Thursday, April 9, 2026, at 6:00 p.m. in the parish hall. We look forward to honoring the Risen Lord with you, and celebrating the Easter season!

Parish-wide

- The fourth St. Joseph consecration preparation course for adults will take place on Sunday, March 8, 2026, at 1:30 p.m. in the parish library, while the fourth workshop for the high school track, incorporating service projects and presentations, will take place at 6:30 p.m. in the parish hall on Wednesday, March 11, 2026.

LENT AND ALMSGIVING

ST. GREGORY THE GREAT

Vainly, then, do those suppose themselves innocent, who claim to their own private use the common gift of God; those who, in not imparting what they have received, walk in the midst of the slaughter of their neighbours; since they almost daily slay so many persons as there are dying poor whose subsidies they keep close in their own possession. For, when we administer necessaries of any kind to the indigent, we do not bestow our own, but render them what is theirs; we rather pay a debt of justice than accomplish works of mercy. Whence also the Truth himself, when speaking of the caution required in showing mercy, says, Take heed that you do not your justice before men" (Matthew 6:1). The Psalmist also, in agreement with this sentence, says, "He has dispersed, he has given to the poor, his justice endures for ever" (Psalm 112:9).

For, having first mentioned bounty bestowed upon the poor, he would not call this mercy, but rather justice: for it is surely just that whosoever receive what is given by a common Lord should use it in common. Hence also Solomon says, "Whoever is just will give and will not spare" (Proverbs 21:26). They are to be admonished also anxiously to take note how of the fig-tree that had no fruit the rigorous husbandman complains that it even cumbers the ground.

For a fig-tree without fruit cumbers the ground, when the soul of the niggardly keeps unprofitably what might have benefited many. A fig-tree without fruit cumbers the ground, when the fool keeps barren under the shade of sloth a place which another might have cultivated under the sun of good works.

~Pastoral Rule, Book III, Chapter 21

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